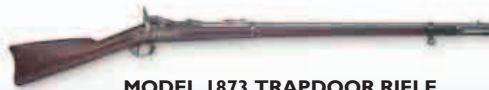




MODEL 1863 TYPE II MUSKET



MODEL 1873 TRAPDOOR RIFLE



M1 GARAND RIFLE

1777 The Springfield Arsenal is founded. As a store for weapons and ammunition, it plays a key role in the Revolutionary War.

1787 Daniel Shays and a group of rebels attempt to capture the arsenal in protest against unfair taxation and the debt collection practices of the Massachusetts state government, but are repelled by the state militia.

1795 Weapons production at the Armory begins with the Springfield "Charleville Pattern" Musket.

1815 Roswell Lee becomes superintendent of the Armory and leads efforts to mechanize production and improve management.

1863 The Model 1863 Type II is the last muzzle-loading long gun produced by the Armory.

1873 The US Army adopts the breech-loading Model 1873 "Trapdoor" rifle.

1936 The semiautomatic M1 Garand rifle is launched. It becomes the first general issue self-loading rifle to be accepted for military service in the US.

1968 Springfield Armory is closed; its buildings are preserved as the Springfield Armory National Historic Site.

Krag rifle, designed in Norway, and the Model 1903, which was designed in Springfield. The retooling and adaptation required to produce these new weapons was a challenge, but thanks to machine upgrades and a reorganization of the workforce, they were successfully put into production and demonstrated that the Armory could build quality firearms en masse. The Armory's Model 1903 was used in both world wars. It was followed by a new generation of semiautomatic firearms, including the famed Garand rifle of 1936, which made US infantrymen much better equipped than those in other parts of the world who were issued with slower bolt-action rifles. Such products kept the Armory going through the mid-20th century, until the US government decided to rely solely on private manufacturers and shut down the facility in 1968.

"It has long been considered a **privilege** to be employed at **Springfield Armory.**"

G. TALCOTT, LT. COL. OF ORDNANCE, ADDRESSING THE US SENATE, 1842

▼ SHARPENING CUTTERS

A woman sharpens cutters for a milling machine at Springfield Armory in around 1943. The cutters were not only used for manufacturing rifle parts but also for building the tools used to make those parts.

